

## Final Defense Dossier

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*Keep this compact. Use evidence bullets, not essays.*

### Day 1 - Debugging Discipline

Strongest debugging evidence:

- Evidence video explaining the debugging process
- A walkthrough from the debugging commands to the final working website

What this proves: The site had around four bugs (occurring in my device) and I fixed them using my command line terminal and by testing the website each time I fixed an error.

### Day 2 - Systems Reasoning

Strongest systems reasoning evidence:

- My ability to decide over the reasoning given by the founder.
- The evidence video explaining what I read through and what I thought could be improved upon.

What this proves: I was correct by choosing to fix the issues occurring in the DB over the notifications UI, it helped to fix the real issue rather than the fancy things which wouldn't work at the end of the day.

### Day 3 - Readiness Verification

Readiness judgment evidence:

- The evidence video including my code files which I edited in order to fix the occurring bugs
- A documentation of everything I changed, specifically my API KEY and API SERVICE KEY which caused me the most issues.

What this proves: The code was almost correct, it didn't have proper requirements to work.

#### Day 4 - Ambiguity Ownership

Ambiguity ownership evidence:

- The documentation I presented talks about the issues I faced while making HireSignal work.
- An evidence video shows the fixes in code and errors in HireSignal's while presenting the AI score.

What this proves: The AI was initially not accurate and the evaluation didn't work. After fixing these present issues and figuring where they occurred, HireSignal was able to work properly.

#### Day 5 - AI Trust Judgment

AI trust judgment evidence:

- I used AI for decision making, and then figured out which option I wanted to pick.
- The log provides evidence for where I trusted AI, and where AI's solutions were misleading, and what suggestions I blocked.

What this proves: AI isn't always accurate during debugging and decision making sessions, this is where an engineer's self decision making skills are handy.

#### Day 6 - Pressure Tradeoff

Pressure tradeoff evidence:

- Handling customers was the pressure window, to overcome it, I fixed the quickest thing which could also help solve the bug.
- Document log:

#### **COMMANDER DECISION BRIEF**

NAME: ALIA ISLAM

Github:

<https://github.com/liacodes49/Career-Forge/tree/day-6-the-pressure-window/day-06-pressure-window>

##### **1. Top Priority**

Protected customer-money trust by containing duplicate charges and preventing further financial harm before addressing secondary issues.

##### **2. Second Priority**

Stabilized communication with support and stakeholders to reduce confusion and preserve customer trust.

What this proves: It's important to prioritize what you want to solve when there's pressure.

Biggest Mistake This Week

What I got wrong: Trusting AI's decisions blindly.

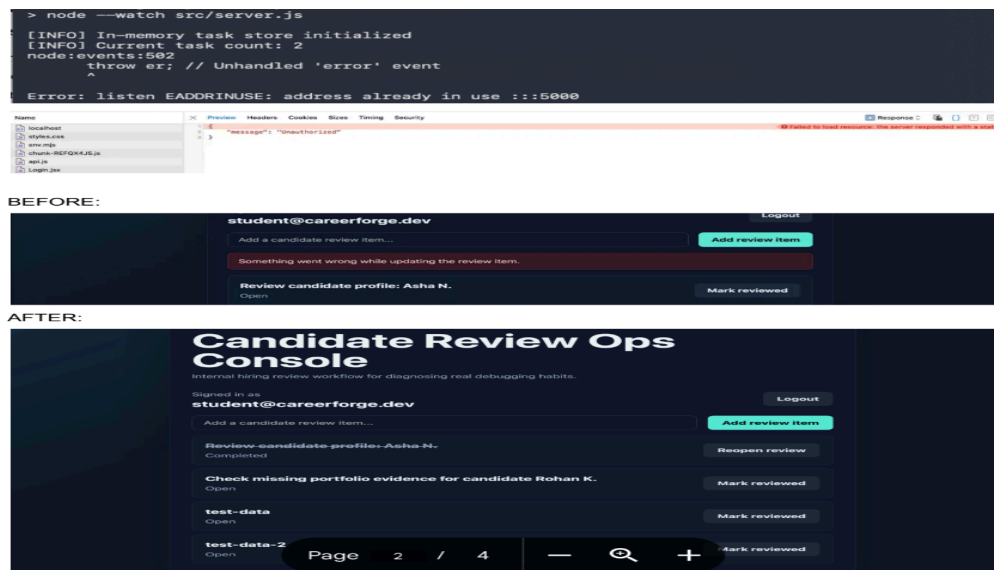
What I learned: An engineer makes their own decisions, especially when it comes to debugging.

What I would do differently now: I want to make backends and fix the errors all by myself, without the help of AI.

Strongest Capability

My strongest capability: Debugging Investigations (DAY 01)

Evidence:



Weakest Capability

My weakest capability: Handling AI's debugging decisions (DAY 05)

Evidence:

### 3. TRUST CLASSIFICATION TABLE

Each recommendation has been independently evaluated against available evidence.

| Recommendation             | AI Claim                        | Classification            | Reason                                                                 |
|----------------------------|---------------------------------|---------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A. Root Cause              | Memory leak from unbounded pool | TRUST (with verification) | Consistent with OOMKilled logs; verify pool metrics first              |
| B. Immediate Fix (restart) | Restart resolves in 5 min       | MODIFY                    | Restart is valid; memory limit increase needs capacity check           |
| B. Memory limit 2Gi        | Increase from 512Mi to 2Gi      | BLOCK until verified      | No capacity baseline provided; could cause node pressure               |
| C. maxPoolSize config      | Set maxPoolSize=10              | TRUST (with testing)      | Reasonable default; must test in staging before prod deploy            |
| C. Skip staging            | Deploy without staging          | BLOCK                     | Zero evidence this is safe; staging is mandatory for DB config changes |
| D. Zero blast radius       | Isolated, no downstream risk    | BLOCK                     | Payments service is never truly isolated; requires transaction audit   |

Next 30-Day Engineering Growth Focus

Growth focus: Debugging and backend development.

Daily/weekly behavior I will practice: I want to practice error solving, and also want to take AI's help while fixing these errors so I can make appropriate decisions accordingly. I want to improve in these two areas particularly.